

THE MIND IS A RASCAL

Topic: The Mind

Q: What is the Mind?

A: The Mind is just a bundle of thoughts. When there are no thoughts, there is no Mind but somehow, the Mind appears to be. We think that we have a Mind. In fact, our Mind makes us believe that we are the Mind. Our Mind is a Thought Factory that is constantly producing thoughts. It has a subtle existence. These thoughts form the Mind.

Source: Chapter 1 – What Is The Mind? | Page 1 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Does the Mind have a physical existence?

A: Our Mind has no physical existence but still, it seems to exist. It is like the software of a computer. It cannot be touched and felt but without it, the computer cannot work. Similarly, without the Mind, a human being is incomplete.

Source: Chapter 1 – What Is The Mind? | Page 1 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What does the Mind produce?

A: Our Mind produces a thought practically, every second. This can be up to 50 thoughts a minute and can amount up to 50,000 thoughts in a day. Our Mind produces both kinds of thoughts, positive and negative. If we feed the Mind with positive raw material, we will have positive thoughts. On the contrary, if we feed the Mind with negative raw material, we will have negative thoughts.

Source: Chapter 1 – What Is The Mind? | Page 1 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Is the Mind really King of our life?

A: Our Mind may appear to be King. It may appear to be everything. But that is the biggest lie. In fact, it is our Mind that is the cause of all our suffering. It is our Mind that inflates our Ego, causes us to fear and live in worry, stress, anxiety and depression. Along with Ego, it becomes ME, that causes anger, hate, revenge and jealousy.

Source: Chapter 2 – The Mind Is King, It Is Everything! | Page 5 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Have you ever seen the Mind?

A: Nobody has ever seen their Mind. The fact is that our Mind is just an illusion. It doesn't exist. It is just a bundle of thoughts that causes our ignorance and makes us believe that it exists. In fact, our ignorance is so deep that we even believe in the existence of our Ego. Our Mind and Ego together become ME and we live and die thinking that we are this Body, Mind and Ego.

Source: Chapter 3 – Have You Seen The Mind? | Page 8 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Is there really no Mind — just thoughts?

A: So, what is the truth about the Mind? There is no Mind! Our Mind is nothing but a bundle of thoughts. When we accumulate thoughts, thought after thought, these thoughts appear as our Mind and we mistake these thoughts to be our Mind itself. If we are able to stop thinking, then in that state of Thoughtlessness, where there are no thoughts, the Mind ceases to exist.

Source: Chapter 7 – There Is No Mind, Just Thoughts! | Page 20 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What does M-I-N-D stand for?

A: When somebody asked me what the Mind is, I said: M is Misery, I is Ignorance, N is Negativity, D is Desires. If we do not destroy the Mind, it will destroy us! Kill the Mind, otherwise the Mind will kill you!

Source: Chapter 12 – Kill The Mind, Before The Mind Kills You! | Page 34 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is the Inner Instrument of our existence?

A: The Inner Instrument consists of the Mind, Memory, Intellect and the Ego. These are in fact, different from the Mind. But most people consider all four of them to be the Mind because all the four are subtle in nature. There is no physical existence of our memory, like a hard disc in a computer. The intellect is also not a physical organ like the heart but it exists and it discriminates.

Source: Chapter 1 – What Is The Mind? | Page 2 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Does the Mind really exist or is it an illusion?

A: The fact is that there is no Mind! Our Mind is caused by ignorance and the ignorance is created by the Mind itself. This self-created ignorance stops us from realizing that our Mind is an illusion. It appears to exist, but in reality, it is just a bundle of thoughts. As long as we allow the Mind to grind us, as long as in thought we are caught, we permit the Mind to take control, it will drill us and kill us.

Source: Chapter 23 – Does The Mind Really Exist? | Page 68 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: How does the Mind create suffering?

A: The Mind, therefore, is the cause of all our pain and suffering. It creates thoughts that steal our Peace and Happiness. Still, we believe that our Mind is our best friend. Why? It is because our Mind makes us think that it is everything. Our Mind makes us believe that without it, we are nothing. But this is the biggest lie. It is, in fact, the cause of all suffering.

Source: Chapter 1 – What Is The Mind? | Page 3 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: How does the Mind create the Ego?

A: It is the Mind that creates the Ego too. Without the Mind, there would be no Ego. Therefore, we do not realize that it is the Mind that is responsible for our anger, hate, revenge and jealousy. Together, the Mind and Ego, ME, create Karma, which not only makes us suffer on earth but is also responsible for our rebirth.

Source: Chapter 1 – What Is The Mind? | Page 3 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What does the Mind want to do to us?

A: Our Mind has a clear agenda. It does not let us realize that it does not exist. It has an illusory existence and it appears to be alive through thoughts. Our Mind bombards us with many thoughts, not permitting us to activate our intellect and discriminate between the thoughts and the existence of the Mind.

Source: Chapter 4 – How Many Thoughts? | Page 11 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is the biggest problem with our Mind?

A: The biggest problem with the Mind is, where it is, we cannot find! In reality, the Mind has no existence. Then, what makes the Mind appear to be? It is our ignorance. Who causes ignorance? It is the Mind itself. Along with the Ego, it becomes ME and fools us into believing that we are this body and we suffer the Triple Suffering – pain of the body, misery of the Mind and agony of the Ego.

Source: Chapter 1 – What Is The Mind? | Page 3 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition).

Q: What happens when the Mind is stilled?

A: The moment we still the Mind, there will be no Mind. When there is no Mind, there will be no thoughts. This state of Thoughtlessness is a state of Consciousness. It is in this state of Consciousness that we can live intelligently, controlling our thoughts, feelings and actions.

Source: Chapter 12 – Kill The Mind, Before The Mind Kills You! | Page 36 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Why is the Mind compared to a Thought Factory?

A: Our Mind is a Thought Factory that is constantly producing thoughts. It produces up to 50 thoughts a minute and that can be up to 50,000 thoughts in a day. Can you imagine how aggressively our Mind works to create fear, stress, anxiety, worry and depression? It destroys our life!

Source: Introduction | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Topic: Fear, Worry and Anxiety

Q: What is fear?

A: Who causes Fear? It is the Mind that causes fear. Fear is not danger. FEAR is a False Expectation Appearing Real. Our Mind creates fear and makes us miserable by producing fearful thoughts. Fear is not a real danger but the thoughts of the Mind create a danger when in reality, there is none and we become miserable.

Source: Chapter 6 – Our Mind Makes Us Miserable! | Page 16 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Why do I worry about the future?

A: The Mind jumps from the past that is gone to a future that is not yet born! The truth is that there is no future. As they say, 'Tomorrow never comes.' It can only appear as 'today' but our Mind is the only rascal that can jump like a monkey from 'yesterday' to 'tomorrow' and create so much misery and sorrow. It creates thoughts of fear, worry, stress and anxiety.

Source: Chapter 5 – The Mind Is A Monkey | Page 13 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What causes anxiety in a person?

A: These aggressive thoughts of the Mind create anxiety attacks and ultimately, lead us into a state of depression. It is in this state that man sometimes even contemplates suicide and if the Mind is not controlled or stilled, there are cases where people end their lives. Therefore, the Mind is a rascal. It is our enemy causing us fear, worry, stress, anxiety and depression.

Source: Chapter 6 – Our Mind Makes Us Miserable! | Page 17 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition).

Q: How can I overcome fear?

A: If we want to achieve the goal of Liberation, all we have to do is to move from the Mind to the intellect and realize that fears are not dangers. As we move away from the Mind, we will not only be free from suffering but we will move closer to our ultimate goal of Liberation.

Source: Chapter 27 – The Goal Is Liberation | Page 80 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition).

Q: Why do people feel insecure and fearful even when there is no real danger?

A: *Our enemy, our Mind will create danger and make us agitated. It will make the wolf look bigger than it is and rob us of our greatest wealth, our Peace and Happiness. FEAR is a False Expectation Appearing Real, worry, stress and anxiety. There will be no danger but our enemy, our Mind will create danger.*

Source: Chapter 28 – Our Mind Is Our Enemy | Page 84 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition).

Q: What is the root cause of stress?

A: Thought after thought, we become worried and anxious. These aggressive thoughts of the Mind create anxiety attacks and ultimately, lead us into a state of depression. Our Mind attacks us with up to 50 thoughts a minute. It does not stop. It produces thousands of thoughts every hour and these thoughts produce stress.

Source: Chapter 6 – Our Mind Makes Us Miserable! | Page 17 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition).

Q: What is the difference between real danger and fear?

A: FEAR is a False Expectation Appearing Real. Our Mind creates fear and makes us miserable by producing fearful thoughts. Fear is not a real danger but the thoughts of the Mind create a danger when in reality, there is none and we become miserable.

Source: Chapter 6 – Our Mind Makes Us Miserable! | Page 16 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Why does the Mind jump into the past and future, stealing the present?

A: Haven't you experienced your Mind jumping to a past that is gone? The past is over. Nobody can go back to the past. But the Mind does. It takes us to events of our history and then creates regret and shame. It makes us nurse, curse, rehearse our past and creates so much misery and unhappiness. And within a few moments, it jumps from the past that is gone to a future that is not yet born.

Source: Chapter 5 – The Mind Is A Monkey | Page 13 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What happens when I am constantly bombarded by fearful thoughts?

A: Just stop and imagine that you have been attacked by about 50 thoughts in a minute. This situation is more dangerous than an AK-47 rifle shooting bullets at you. If shot with a rifle, you

will be dead in a moment but if bombarded with thoughts from your Mind, you will suffer every moment, till you die.

Source: Chapter 4 – How Many Thoughts? | Page 11 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Can I stop worrying by controlling my thoughts?

A: We can control thoughts by being in Silence. The world calls it 'Meditation' without realizing the true meaning of meditation. Meditation is the process of stilling the Mind. We have to reduce the MTR, the Mental Thought Rate. Slowly, we reach that state where there are no thoughts. In this state, when we control all thoughts, we are in Consciousness.

Source: Chapter 8 – Can We Control Our Thoughts? | Page 23 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Why do successful and seemingly happy people fall into depression?

A: Have you ever wondered why a rich, successful, happy man suddenly commits suicide? Who made that decision to kill oneself? It is the Mind! When the Mind becomes the boss, there is no way to stop this loss. In a fraction of a moment, your Mind can make you hang down a rope, shoot yourself or jump from the top of a building.

Source: Chapter 18 – Be The Boss | Page 54 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is NEP and how does it relate to fear?

A: NEP is Negative Energy that is Poison, the negative emotions that we feed our Mind that create poison in our life. Emotions like fear, worry, stress, anxiety, anger, hate, revenge, jealousy and pessimism. The very thought of such emotions creates depression in our life.

Source: Chapter 9 – From NEP To PEP | Page 26 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: How does fear affect my mental health?

A: Scientists accept that our Mind can do a lot of damage, and not just through thoughts. Many scientific studies have proven that our Mind can also be responsible for the release of hormones and chemicals that may affect the physical aspect of our life. That is why, there are so many psychiatrists who are working day and night to improve the study and diagnosis of the treatment for various mental illnesses.

Source: Chapter 29 – The Mind And Science | Page 86 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is the relationship between fear and ignorance?

A: Our Mind keeps us enveloped in the darkness of ignorance and stops us from the Realization of the truth. And because of this ignorance, we continue to suffer. Our Mind appears to make us glad but in the next moment, it makes us sad. It attracts us towards pleasure but ultimately, gives us pain.

Source: Chapter 6 – Our Mind Makes Us Miserable! | Page 18 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is the ultimate solution to fear, worry, and anxiety?

A: If we still the Mind, we can live in the present moment without being pulled into the past or the future. Without the Mind, we can discriminate with our intellect and make the right choices. The Mind stops us from all this. It is the cause of our unhappiness. Thus, it's time to realize who our greatest enemy is.

Source: Chapter 28 – Our Mind Is Our Enemy | Page 84 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Topic: Consciousness And Meditation

Q: What is Consciousness?

A: *What is this state of Consciousness? It is the state of Thoughtlessness, where the Mind does not bombard us with thoughts. The Mind becomes still! In this state of Consciousness or Thoughtlessness, we find Peace and Bliss.*

Source: Chapter 14 – From Mind To Consciousness | Page 40 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: How do I move from Mind to Consciousness?

A: For beginners, Silence or Meditation is a way to calm the Mind. As long as we are caught in the web of our senses, we see, hear, smell, taste and touch, our thoughts go into the outside world. When we silence our body and its senses, we still our Mind. When a thought comes, we watch it, catch it, and latch it.

Source: Chapter 14 – From Mind To Consciousness | Page 40 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

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Source: Chapter 14 – From Mind To Consciousness | Page 40 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is the true meaning of Meditation?

A: We can control thoughts by being in Silence. The world calls it 'Meditation' without realizing the true meaning of meditation. Meditation is the process of stilling the Mind. We have to reduce the MTR, the Mental Thought Rate. Slowly, we reach that state where there are no thoughts. The Buddhists refer to this as Mindfulness.

Source: Chapter 8 – Can We Control Our Thoughts? | Page 23 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is Mindfulness?

A: In a state of Thoughtlessness, there are no dreams and no misery. Other than this state, our Mind constantly bombards us with thoughts and makes us miserable. When we are in a state of Mind state of Thoughtlessness or Mindfulness, we experience Peace and Bliss.

Source: Chapter 6 – Our Mind Makes Us Miserable! | Page 16 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: How does one experience Peace of Mind?

A: What is Peace of Mind? It is a state of Stillness. In reality, we do not have to find Peace. It is within. We just have to still the Mind. Now, what is the Mind? It is only a cluster of thoughts. Can we stop thinking? Of course. Just like we can stop walking and talking, we can stop thinking! But it is not easy.

Source: Chapter 8 – Can We Control Our Thoughts? | Page 23 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What role does silence play in stilling the Mind?

A: To stop this yelling, we must spend time in silence. We must meditate and contemplate in Consciousness. We must move from a state of Mind to a state of intellect, from thoughts to Thoughtlessness. Then, this yelling will stop and the tail will drop.

Source: Chapter 17 – Cut The Monkey's Tail | Page 50 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is the experience of deep, dreamless sleep telling us about Consciousness?

A: Have you not experienced a state of deep sleep when there was no dream? We wake up from such a sleep and say, 'I slept like a log!' In this state of deep sleep, we have the rare experience of being thoughtless and in Bliss. In a state of Thoughtlessness, there are no dreams and no misery.

Source: Chapter 6 – Our Mind Makes Us Miserable! | Page 16 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: How can I know if I have entered a state of Consciousness?

A: Some people wonder how we can differentiate between a state of Mind and a state of Consciousness, in which the intellect shines. When we are not bombarded by thoughts anymore and we are in a state of Peace and Happiness, we can be aware that we are in a state of Consciousness.

Source: Chapter 14 – From Mind To Consciousness | Page 41 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is the MTR and how does reducing it help?

A: The solution is to cut the MTR, the Mental Thought Rate. Just like there is a BMR, the Basal Metabolic Rate, our body's metabolic rate by which we burn calories, MTR is our Mental Thought Rate. Normally, it is up to 50 thoughts, per minute. If we use our Consciousness, intellect and willpower to slow down our Mind, then we can reduce the MTR from 50 to 40, to 30 and ultimately, to 1 thought a minute.

Source: Chapter 4 – How Many Thoughts? | Page 12 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What happens in the state of Thoughtlessness?

A: If we are able to stop thinking, then in that state of Thoughtlessness, where there are no thoughts, the Mind ceases to exist. There is no Mind and thus, no misery of the Mind. We experience a state of deep Bliss and Peace.

Source: Chapter 7 – There Is No Mind, Just Thoughts! | Page 20 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: How does Consciousness activate the intellect?

A: In the light of Consciousness, our intellect is activated. Our intellect is a flip side of the coin, where the other side is the Mind. When we flip into the intellect mode, our Mind is dormant and our intellect is in command. It discriminates every thought. Thoughts will then, not pour like rain, rather they will gently appear one after the other in our intellect.

Source: Chapter 14 – From Mind To Consciousness | Page 41 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is the watch, catch and latch technique?

A: When a thought appears, we watch it, catch it and latch it! We have to have a strong willpower and a sharp intellect that appears only in Consciousness. This is a tug of war within us that will never stop. The only difference will be, who will be the Master, thoughts of the Mind or stillness of the Consciousness.

Source: Chapter 8 – Can We Control Our Thoughts? | Page 24 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Is it really possible to stop thinking?

A: Until we stop this thinking, we will never realize that our Mind, which we cannot find, doesn't actually exist. It is just a bundle of thoughts. How can we realize this? We have to stop thinking. How do we stop thinking? Just like we can stop walking, talking or eating, we can discipline ourselves to stop thinking too.

Source: Chapter 4 – How Many Thoughts? | Page 11 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Why is it said that 'the one who has conquered the Mind has conquered the world'?

A: The one who has conquered his Mind, has conquered the world.' Why do people say this? They say this because it is the truth! Conquering anything in this world is easier than conquering the Mind. Our Mind is a very powerful force. It does not exist in the physical world and it affects every breath of our life.

Source: Chapter 14 – From Mind To Consciousness | Page 40 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is the relationship between Consciousness and Liberation?

A: If we flip from Mind to Consciousness and live as a witness, an observer realizing the truth that we are not ME, the Mind and Ego, there will be no Karma. If there is no Karma, there will be no rebirth. We may know this but we are unable to actualize it because our Mind stops us from this Realization.

Source: Chapter 22 – 'ME' Is The One That Is Reborn | Page 65 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Topic: The Ego

Q: What is the Ego?

A: We keep talking about the Ego. But what is this Ego? Where does it come from? The Ego is the identity of 'me', the one who appears in the body. The first endorsement of the Ego is our name. Our birth certificate tells us who we are, when we were born and carries details of 'me', the Ego.

Source: Chapter 19 – The Mind And Ego Becomes 'ME' | Page 55 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How does the Mind create the Ego?

A: Our Mind is the one that inflates our Ego. It drives our Ego forward and forms ME, the Mind and Ego. It makes us feel that 'I' am different from 'you'. Of course, I am this body and you are that body. Then, how can 'I' be 'you'? Our Mind through our Ego separates us into two separate beings.

Source: Chapter 19 – The Mind And Ego Becomes 'ME' | Page 55 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What does ME stand for?

A: The Mind along with the Ego creates the ME that we see in the mirror and this is all we are able to be, till we die. We are unable to discover the truth of 'Who am I?' because our Ego keeps on saying, 'I want to be an engineer. I want to buy a car.' We get so caught in the ME, that we are unable to be who we truly are.

Source: Chapter 19 – The Mind And Ego Becomes 'ME' | Page 56 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How does the Ego cause suffering?

A: The Mind, along with the Ego, creates thoughts of hatred that makes us miserable. Have you ever seen your right hand getting angry at your left hand or your left leg kicking your right leg? This never happens because we know that they both belong to us. Similarly, while we have different bodies, the truth is that we are all Souls that belong to one Supreme Power.

Source: Chapter 6 – Our Mind Makes Us Miserable! | Page 17 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Can I ever be free from the Ego?

A: A very few amongst us are fortunate who still the Mind and kill the Mind. We go on a quest to find out 'Who am I'. Then, we realize that I am not 'I' and this Realization makes us free from the Mind and Ego, ME. When we still the Mind and there are no thoughts, there is no Ego. The Ego disappears.

Source: Chapter 19 – The Mind And Ego Becomes 'ME' | Page 57 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the 'Triple Suffering' caused by the Mind and Ego?

A: In reality, we are not ME, the Mind and Ego. But our Mind makes us believe that we are. It binds us to this world and makes us believe all the lies. Not only will we suffer the Triple Suffering that we experience on earth – the pain of the body, misery of the Mind and agony of the Ego – but the ME also causes repeated rebirth.

Source: Chapter 22 – 'ME' Is The One That Is Reborn | Page 64 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Does the Ego really exist?

A: Can you see the 'ME'? No! You can see your nose, eyes and head. But there is no ME! ME is a false identity. Our goal is to transcend our Mind and Ego, ME, created by our Rascal Mind. In reality, there is no 'I'. The moment we realize this, we become free.

Source: Chapter 19 – The Mind And Ego Becomes 'ME' | Page 56 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What happens to the Ego when we kill the Mind?

A: When we still the Mind and there are no thoughts, there is no Ego. The Ego disappears. Therefore, we must focus to kill the Mind. Only then, will we transcend our Ego. Till we do this, our Mind will keep pushing our Ego into depths of ignorance.

Source: Chapter 19 – The Mind And Ego Becomes 'ME' | Page 57 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: How does the Ego stop us from realizing who we truly are?

A: It is our Ego that stops us from the Realization of the truth. It is ME, the Mind and Ego, that stops us from Enlightenment. The Mind along with the Ego creates the ME that we see in the mirror and this is all we are able to be, till we die. We are unable to discover the truth of 'Who am I?'

Source: Chapter 19 – The Mind And Ego Becomes 'ME' | Page 56 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is the relationship between Ego and Karma?

A: While we are thinking of killing our Mind, it is very important to understand the relationship between the Mind, Ego and Karma. It is the ME, the Mind and Ego, that because of Karma, is born again and again. It is the Law of Karma that brought us to earth. If there was no Karma, we would not have taken this human birth.

Source: Chapter 20 – The Mind And Ego 'ME' Creates Karma | Page 59 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Why does the Ego say 'I am this body'?

A: Our Mind makes us suffer as the body by making us believe that we are the Body, Mind and the Ego. Thus, our Mind makes us suffer physical pain throughout our life. Our Mind makes us believe that we are the Body, Mind and Ego. This is the biggest myth we have grown up with.

Source: Chapter 24 – Are We The Body That Dies? | Page 71 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What creates the sense of 'I' in a person?

A: Ego can be experienced only in living creatures. The sense of 'I', 'me' and 'mine' seems to exist in all living beings but it is the highest in human beings. The Mind says, 'Because I think, I am,' and the Ego says, 'Because I am, I think.' In both ways, when we think, we blink and we sink.

Source: Chapter 19 – The Mind And Ego Becomes 'ME' | Page 56 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Why do people fight and get angry at each other?

A: The Mind, along with the Ego, creates thoughts of hatred that makes us miserable. While we have different bodies, the truth is that we are all Souls that belong to one Supreme Power. We are actually one but because the Mind creates duality, we get angry at each other.

Source: Chapter 6 – Our Mind Makes Us Miserable! | Page 17 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Can the Ego be transcended through Enlightenment?

A: Our goal is to transcend our Mind and Ego, ME, created by our Rascal Mind. The truth is that we are the Divine Soul but we are unable to realize it because of the Mind and Ego, ME. The moment we are able to still the Mind and kill the Mind, our Ego will automatically, die.

Source: Chapter 19 – The Mind And Ego Becomes 'ME' | Page 57 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: How does the Ego relate to greed and desire?

A: The Ego also develops greed. We want to be rich, famous, successful and wealthy because our Mind along with our Ego separates us from the others in this world. The Ever-Yearning Mind says, 'I want this, I want that!' It doesn't know how to stop even after we fulfil our needs. It gets caught in greed.

Source: Chapter 17 – Cut The Monkey's Tail | Page 50 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

TOPIC: KARMA AND REBIRTH

Q: What is Karma?

A: Karma is a law. It is the Universal Law of Action and Reaction that governs everything that happens in this world. Nobody can escape from Karma. This law is based on the principle, 'As you sow, so shall you reap.' Therefore, if you perform any action, you cannot escape from Karma. Everything happening in our life is unfolding as per Karma.

Source: Chapter 20 – The Mind And Ego 'ME' Creates Karma | Page 58 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Who creates Karma?

A: While it is the body that does the Karma, does the Karma belong to the body? Our body is only an instrument of action. Neither is it responsible for doing Karma nor does Karma belong to the body. In fact, ME, the Mind and Ego, own the Karmic Account of our life.

Source: Chapter 20 – The Mind And Ego 'ME' Creates Karma | Page 58 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Do thoughts create Karma?

A: Karma is not a thought. Karma is an action and as long as there is no action, there is no Karma and no consequence of Karma that will lead to a reaction. The Law of Karma that controls our destiny is not based on our thoughts but based on our actions.

Source: Chapter 21 – Thoughts Don't Create Karma | Page 61 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Why are we reborn?

A: Why are we born? Why do we return to earth in a rebirth? The Karma carried forward by the Mind and Ego, ME, decided our parents, nationality, gender, date and other aspects of our birth. As we live today, we are doing actions and recording fresh Karma every day. Those Karma may be good or bad but every Karma that we record is like a chain that binds us to this earth and causes our rebirth.

Source: Chapter 22 – 'ME' Is The One That Is Reborn | Page 65 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Who is reborn after death?

A: Unless we kill our Mind, still our Mind, transcend our Ego and let go of it, we cannot escape Karma and rebirth. If we flip from Mind to Consciousness and live as a witness, an observer realizing the truth that we are not ME, the Mind and Ego, there will be no Karma. If there is no Karma, there will be no rebirth.

Source: Chapter 22 – 'ME' Is The One That Is Reborn | Page 65 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What is the goal of human life according to the author?

A: Our goal is to be liberated, to be free from all suffering on earth and from rebirth too. But our Mind does not permit this. It keeps on grilling us and killing us because the moment we are enlightened with the truth, the Mind remains no more! The Ego will be dead. In the moment of death of the body, if we realize that we are not the Mind and Ego, ME, there will be no rebirth.

Source: Chapter 27 – The Goal Is Liberation | Page 79 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Is good Karma enough for Liberation?

A: Our Mind occasionally fools us and makes us do good Karma. But whether it is good or bad Karma, we are caught in the cycle of transmigration, the cycle of death and rebirth. Good Karma will not free us from the cycle of rebirth but we are unable to realize this truth because of the thoughts in our Mind.

Source: Chapter 21 – Thoughts Don't Create Karma | Page 63 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: What happens after death to the Mind and Ego?

A: Our suffering does not end at death. Our Mind not only makes us suffer the Triple Suffering on earth but along with our Ego, it becomes the ME that returns in a rebirth and makes us suffer, again and again. Our Mind keeps us enveloped in the darkness of ignorance and stops us from the Realization of the truth.

Source: Chapter 6 – Our Mind Makes Us Miserable! | Page 18 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)

Q: Why is a child sometimes born with difficulties or handicaps?

A: Every time somebody is born, they carry with them, the unsettled Karma of their past life. That is why sometimes, a child is born blind. It is not because God is not kind. It is because the ME, the Mind and Ego has carried its Karma into a new birth on earth.

Source: Chapter 20 – The Mind And Ego 'ME' Creates Karma | Page 59 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is Moksha or Liberation?

A: Why doesn't the ME want us to be free? The moment we defeat the Mind and dissolve the Ego and there is no ME, then there will be no Karma and rebirth. In such a scenario, we have destroyed our Mind and escaped the cycle of death and rebirth. This state is known as Mukti or Freedom, Moksha, Nirvana or Salvation.

Source: Chapter 22 – 'ME' Is The One That Is Reborn | Page 66 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the Karmic Account?

A: ME, the Mind and Ego, own the Karmic Account of our life. Our body is the instrument of action and it is also the one that experiences whatever happens in our life. But it only passes on the experience to ME, the Mind and Ego that ultimately, feels the pleasure or the pain.

Source: Chapter 20 – The Mind And Ego 'ME' Creates Karma | Page 59 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How are actions and Karma connected through the Thought Chain?

A: Every time it produces a thought, it triggers feelings that not only lead to actions but also become habits. Therefore, thoughts are very dangerous. If we do not control our thoughts, we are very likely to be caught in the action that will follow and then we will be trapped in the Karmic Cycle.

Source: Chapter 21 – Thoughts Don't Create Karma | Page 61 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Is our destiny pre-determined or in our hands?

A: No doubt, some things in our life, the circumstances that unfold, unfold as per our past Karma, our past actions. But thereafter, we have been given a free will. We have been given a freedom of choice. We can choose our present actions, form our present Karma. Our destiny is in our hands despite our past Karma. But our attitude will always depend on our emotions.

Source: Chapter 10 – The Thought Chain | Page 30 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What stops us from realizing the truth and achieving Liberation?

A: Our Mind is holding us back from our ultimate goal of realizing that we are the Divine Soul. Our Mind is stopping us from attaining Liberation and Unification. It keeps on bombarding us with thoughts and it is an expert in creating FEAR, a False Expectation Appearing Real. The moment there is Liberation and Unification, we will no more carry Karma and return to earth in a rebirth.

Source: Chapter 27 – The Goal Is Liberation | Page 79 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Topic: PEACE AND HAPPINESS

Q: What is the difference between pleasure and true Happiness?

A: While many of us enjoy pleasure and think it is Happiness, in reality, it is not! Pleasure is just a momentary joy. It comes and goes. It is ephemeral. If we want true Happiness, we need to have Peace. Peace is the foundation on which the tower of Bliss is built.

***Source:** Chapter 30 – Our Mind Steals Our Peace | Page 88 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Why do I struggle to find Peace?

A: Many of us are in search of Peace. It is impossible to find Peace outside because Peace is within us. If we want Peace, we must still the Mind. And then, Peace, we will find. Our life is like a lake. As long as this lake is still, it is peaceful. But the moment there are ripples in the lake, the stillness is lost and with it, Peace is lost too.

***Source:** Chapter 30 – Our Mind Steals Our Peace | Page 88 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How does the Mind steal our Peace?

A: It is our own Mind that steals our Peace. So, how does our Mind steal our Peace? Our Mind is nothing but a bundle of thoughts. It is a Thought Factory that constantly produces thoughts. These thoughts steal our Peace. By default, the Mind is programmed to think negative thoughts and fill us with NEP, Negative Energy Poison.

***Source:** Chapter 30 – Our Mind Steals Our Peace | Page 89 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Is Happiness a result of success and achievement?

A: Most people are chasing success, name and fame to be happy but are all successful people, happy? We see not. On the contrary, it is happy people that are successful. Our Mind makes us believe that to be glad, we must be rich and so, we chase money and wealth only to become sad in the end.

***Source:** Chapter 25 – Realize The Truth | Page 75 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How can I experience Bliss?

A: The moment we kill the Monkey Mind, Peace and Bliss, we will find! It is only in the state of Thoughtlessness, when there is no Mind, that we can experience Consciousness and in Consciousness, we will find Peace, Bliss, Love and Joy.

***Source:** Chapter 30 – Our Mind Steals Our Peace | Page 89 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the foundation of Happiness?

A: Peace is the foundation of Happiness and it is within but we do not find Peace because our Mind bombards us with thoughts. Our Mind appears to make us glad but in the next moment, it makes us sad. It attracts us towards pleasure but ultimately, gives us pain. The Mind makes us miserable, again and again.

***Source:** Chapter 6 – Our Mind Makes Us Miserable! | Page 18 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What causes our unhappiness?

A: Our Mind steals our Happiness. It appears to create desires and when these desires are fulfilled, it appears to cause pleasure but this pleasure is momentary. Soon, we are tormented by pain, by these very desires of our Mind. The Mind constantly bombards us with thoughts. Soon we find that there is no Peace.

Source: Chapter 28 – *Our Mind Is Our Enemy* | Page 82 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How does PEP help us experience Happiness?

A: If we learn to fill our life with PEP or Positive Emotions that create Power, we will win half the battle with our Mind. If we choose emotions like Optimism, Faith, Hope, Belief, Trust, Courage, Confidence and Forgiveness, then we are supplying positive raw material to our Thought Factory, our Mind, to produce positive thoughts.

Source: Chapter 9 – *From NEP To PEP* | Page 26 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the highest peak of Happiness?

A: The ultimate peak of happiness is beyond Achievement and Fulfilment. It is Enlightenment, Liberation from misery and suffering and experiencing Eternal Happiness, Divine Love and Everlasting Peace. What is it to realize the truth? The truth is that every 'body' must die. The truth is that nothing is mine. Still, the Mind and Ego, ME, makes us believe that this is 'my' car, 'my' house.

Source: Chapter 25 – *Realize The Truth* | Page 74 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Why do we suffer even when conditions seem good?

A: Our suffering does not end at death. Our Mind not only makes us suffer the Triple Suffering on earth but along with our Ego, it becomes the ME that returns in a rebirth and makes us suffer, again and again. Our challenge in life is to realize that our Mind is neither our friend nor King.

Source: Chapter 6 – *Our Mind Makes Us Miserable!* | Page 18 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What must we realize for permanent Peace?

A: We must remember that the Mind does not know the meaning of positive thoughts. It has taught us lies right from when we were in school. Our Mind has a clear agenda. To steal our Peace, rob our Bliss and drown us in ignorance. The Mind is a rascal and it is our biggest enemy.

Source: Chapter 30 – *Our Mind Steals Our Peace* | Page 89 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Is there a permanent state of inner peace possible?

A: There is also some good news. As we kill the Mind that is like Phoenix, it becomes weaker and weaker. Every time we kill the Mind, we destroy its potency of breaking into our Consciousness. But to reach a state where our Mind is powerless, is a long process. We have to go through a lot of practice and discipline and use our intellect and willpower.

Source: Chapter 15 – *The Mind Is Like The Phoenix* | Page 44 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Why does the Mind not want us to be happy?

A: Our Mind is our biggest enemy. It does not want us to be happy. That is why it steals our Peace, the very foundation of Happiness. How? By bombarding us with thoughts. When in thought we are caught, what we forgot, is that the Mind is destroying us. Thought by thought, our Mind is draining and killing us without us realizing it.

Source: Chapter 18 – Be The Boss | Page 52 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the relationship between Happiness, Peace, and the Soul?

A: We do not experience Peace and Bliss of the Soul. Until we kill the Mind and flip over to Consciousness, we will never activate our intellect, discriminate and realize the truth. Our goal is to realize that we are the Soul, the Atman and part of the Supreme Immortal Power, SIP.

Source: Chapter 25 – Realize The Truth | Page 74 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

TOPIC: Mind vs intellect

Q: What is the intellect?

A: The intellect is also a part of our subtle existence. It helps us to discriminate and choose. The intellect is the enemy of the Mind. Therefore, our Mind tries to camouflage our intellect so that it is not seen to exist as an important and powerful part of our life.

Source: Chapter 16 – Mind Vs Intellect | Page 46 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the difference between the Mind and the intellect?

A: Our Mind fools us into believing that within its domain is our intellect and our intellect is not a different entity but that is a lie. The intellect is the enemy of the Mind. The Mind is a Thought Factory. It produces thoughts but our intellect helps us discriminate between right and wrong, relevant and irrelevant.

Source: Chapter 16 – Mind Vs Intellect | Page 46 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Who should be King — the Mind or the intellect?

A: When the Mind is killed, in that moment of stillness or Thoughtlessness, we reach a state of Consciousness. It is in the light of this Consciousness that our intellect shines. Then, the new King, the intellect takes charge of our life. There is Peace which was erstwhile robbed by our Mind.

Source: Chapter 2 – The Mind Is King, It Is Everything! | Page 5 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How can I activate the intellect?

A: Our intellect can be activated only in a state of Consciousness. Consciousness is a state of Thoughtlessness. When we are bombarded with thoughts, our Mind behaves like a rushing river. It does not permit the dam of the intellect to be built to control the gushing waters of the Mind. The moment we are in Consciousness, there are no thoughts. In that state where there is no bombardment from the Mind, we can activate our intellect.

Source: Chapter 16 – Mind Vs Intellect | Page 47 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What does intellect do that the Mind cannot?

A: In the state of intellect, the Mind gets frozen. The pouring raindrops become snowflakes that gently fall, one-by-one. With these gentle thoughts entering our Consciousness when our intellect is in command, the intellect is able to discriminate the thoughts, eliminating those thoughts that are irrelevant for our life.

Source: Chapter 16 – Mind Vs Intellect | Page 47 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What happens when the Mind is in command of our life?

A: If our Mind is in charge, then we will surely be stressed out with anxiety attacks and be in a state of panic, fear, worry and depression. But if our intellect is in command, then we are in charge of our life, thoughts, feelings, actions and finally, our destiny.

Source: Chapter 16 – Mind Vs Intellect | Page 48 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the biggest game of human life?

A: The biggest game of our life is the game of Mind vs Intellect. Who is in command of our life? If our Mind is in charge, then we will surely be stressed out with anxiety attacks. But if our intellect is in command, then we are in charge of our life, thoughts, feelings, actions and finally, our destiny. Therefore, life is all about killing the Mind and activating the intellect.

Source: Chapter 16 – Mind Vs Intellect | Page 47 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the chariot of life and the intellect's role?

A: It is said in the Bhagavad Gita, 'Our life is like a chariot with five horses. The five horses are the five senses. With these five sense perceptions, our Mind connects with the outside world and goes wild. What is the solution? The solution is that our intellect must become the charioteer holding the reins, our Mind and control the horses, the senses. Only then, can we be the boss of our life.'

Source: Chapter 18 – Be The Boss | Page 53 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Why does the Mind suppress the intellect?

A: The software of our life is not just our Mind. Our subtle body consists of the Mind, Intellect, Memory and Ego. Unless we realize this and activate our intellect to overcome ignorance, our Mind will keep bombarding us with thoughts and make us believe that we are the ME, the Mind and Ego. It will suppress our intellect and its power to discriminate.

Source: Chapter 16 – Mind Vs Intellect | Page 47 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How does discrimination by the intellect help us avoid bad Karma?

A: The moment we still the Mind, we realize the truth that we are carrying a bad thought in our head. Immediately, the intellect shoots down the thought through discrimination. It stops the thought from germinating into a feeling and action and saves us from Karma.

Source: Chapter 21 – Thoughts Don't Create Karma | Page 62 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is man's greatest treasure?

A: The intellect is man's greatest treasure. The Mind is nothing but a rascal. Before it destroys us, we should destroy it. This evolved Realization has inspired me to write the second edition of the book, 'The Mind is a Rascal'.

Source: Chapter 18 – Be The Boss | Page 54 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How does the intellect help in the state of Consciousness?

A: In a state of Consciousness, where there are no thoughts, our intellect is activated. Like the Mind, the intellect is also a part of our subtle existence. It helps us to discriminate and choose. In the state of Mind, thoughts bombard us. But in Consciousness, thoughts appear one-by-one, like cable cars or gondolas on a ropeway. Each thought is then, discriminated.

Source: Chapter 18 – Be The Boss | Page 56 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the Realization that the intellect leads us to?

A: Realizing the truth of the Body, Mind, Ego, and the Soul is the final goal of the Intellect. However, we do not get to reach this point of Realization known as Enlightenment because our Mind does not permit us to do so. Our Mind bombards us with thoughts and in thought, we are caught. Until we activate the intellect, our Mind rules over us.

Source: Chapter 16 – Mind Vs Intellect | Page 47 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How does the intellect differ from the Mind in the context of thoughts?

A: What is the difference between raining and snowing? When it rains, it pours. Thoughts pour like rain. They pull us down the drain and we suffer pain, again and again. But when it snows, each snowflake falls gently from the skies. These snowflakes are like thoughts that gently appear in our intellect.

Source: Chapter 13 – To Kill The Mind, Still The Mind | Page 38 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

TOPIC: THE SOUL AND SELF-REALIZATION

Q: Who am I, in reality?

A: The truth is that we are the Divine Soul. We are a Spark Of Unique Life. We are energy. This energy commences our life through a process of fertilization. The first cell of the zygote multiplies into 2, 4, 8, 16, till it becomes a tiny baby. We are that Power of life that grows from a zygote to an embryo and finally, a human body.

Source: Chapter 26 – We Are The Immortal Soul | Page 77 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Are we the body that dies?

A: What happens in the moment of death? At death, the body dies and returns to the 5 elements of nature. People say that we passed away. But death reveals beyond doubt that we are not the body that dies. This also reveals that throughout life, the body is just a habitat in which we live.

Source: Chapter 26 – We Are The Immortal Soul | Page 77 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Are we the body that dies?

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Source: Chapter 24 – Are We The Body That Dies? | Page 71 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the SOUL?

A: We are the SOUL, the Spark Of Unique Life that was conceived at fertilization, the fusion of our parent cells. We are the Immortal Soul, the Power of life that arrives at conception and departs at death. The fact is that 'we' never die. Only the body dies. We are energy and even science confirms that energy cannot be created or destroyed.

Source: Chapter 26 – We Are The Immortal Soul | Page 78 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What stops us from realizing we are the Soul?

A: Why is it that we do not realize that we are the Immortal Soul? Our Mind does not want us to realize that we are the Soul because the moment we realize it, the Mind is no more! The Mind and Ego, ME, will be dead and we will be free from the cycle of death and rebirth.

Source: Chapter 26 – We Are The Immortal Soul | Page 78 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is Enlightenment?

A: What is it to realize the truth? The truth is that every 'body' must die. The truth is that nothing is mine. The truth is that we bring nothing with us when we arrive on the planet and we will take nothing with us when we depart. To realize the truth is to overcome all ignorance. This state of knowing — 'Who am I?' — is what we call Enlightenment.

Source: Chapter 25 – Realize The Truth | Page 74 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the purpose of human life?

A: While we have been given this human birth for Enlightenment, for using our intellect and realizing the truth, it is unfortunate that most of us just live and die, and we do not realize the truth of 'Who am I?' For most people, the truth is what it is — their name, occupation or relationship — but none of this is the truth of who we really are.

Source: Chapter 25 – Realize The Truth | Page 73 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What does 'We are the Immortal Soul' mean?

A: The fact is that 'we' never die. Only the body dies. We are energy and even science confirms that energy cannot be created or destroyed. It can only be transformed from one form to another. We are not this Body, Mind and Ego, we are the Power of life that is throbbing within. The ultimate goal of our life is to realize this.

Source: Chapter 26 – We Are The Immortal Soul | Page 78 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Why is our birthday said to be 'fake'?

A: We celebrate our birthday and we even cut a cake but the truth is that our birthday is fake. We were actually born nine months earlier, when two cells, one each from our parents, fertilized and formed the zygote. In that moment of creation of that cell, our existence was initiated.

Source: Chapter 24 – Are We The Body That Dies? | Page 70 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What happens after death — heaven or rebirth?

A: Our Mind again confuses us. It makes us believe that we will go to heaven or hell. In the desire to achieve heaven, we try to do good deeds and we get caught in the cycle of rebirth as we are creating good Karma. Our Mind fools us here, again. Good Karma will not free us from the cycle of rebirth.

Source: Chapter 21 – Thoughts Don't Create Karma | Page 63 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the role of a Guru or Spiritual Master?

A: It was my Guru's guidance that made me go beyond my Mind and my Ego. It was through discrimination that I realized that doing what I loved, gave me far more Happiness than running like a horse, making money that would ultimately, not belong to me at all. Slowly but steadily, I killed my Mind.

Source: Chapter 27- Afterword | Page 92 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is meant by 'Realize the Truth'?

A: We know that a dream is a dream but we do not realize that life itself is a dream and because our Mind makes us believe this life drama to be real, we suffer the misery of the Body, Mind and Ego. A small minority of humanity goes on a quest for the truth. They ask questions about themselves, about life, God and go to the bottom of the root till they realize the truth.

Source: Chapter 25 – Realize The Truth | Page 74 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Are we born with nothing and do we die with nothing?

A: Nothing is mine. The truth is that we bring nothing with us when we arrive on the planet and we will take nothing with us when we depart. Still, the Mind and Ego, ME, makes us believe that this is 'my' car, 'my' house. Even though we know that this body is not ours and we have to leave it when we depart, our Mind fools us.

Source: Chapter 25 – Realize The Truth | Page 74 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How does the author describe his own journey to Enlightenment?

A: For 25 years, I achieved Success after Success, thinking that Success is Happiness. Then, when I tried to find my Mind, where it was, I could not find! I was running like a mad man behind illusions of this world that would ultimately not belong to me. I had wasted 25 years, the prime time of my life chasing Success and Achievement, just because of my Mind.

Source: Chapter 27 - Afterword | Page 92 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the ultimate goal — Liberation or Unification?

A: Our goal is to be liberated, to be free from all suffering on earth and from rebirth too. Our Goal is Liberation from the Cycle of Rebirth. Our Goal is to be Free from the Mind and Ego, ME, and become one with SIP, the Supreme Divine Energy.

Source: Chapter 27 – The Goal Is Liberation | Page 81 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What percentage of humanity realizes the truth about the Mind and Soul?

A: Unfortunately, less than 1% of the human race realizes that the Mind is like a monkey, it is a rascal and our enemy. 99% of humanity is Spiritually blind and cannot see the Truth. Only 1% goes on a Quest and realizes that the Mind is a rascal, a monkey. It is our biggest enemy that steals our Peace and Liberation.

Source: Chapter 2 – *The Mind Is King, It Is Everything!* | Page 6 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

TOPIC: THE MONKEY MIND

Q: Why is the Mind called the Monkey Mind?

A: Many philosophers also refer to it as the 'Monkey Mind'. It is so because a monkey jumps from branch to branch and similarly, the Mind jumps from thought to thought. It does not stay still. Therefore, it steals both our present moment and Peace.

Source: Chapter 5 – *The Mind Is A Monkey* | Page 13 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the EY in MonkEY?

A: If you observe the word, 'monkey', then without its tail, EY, it becomes a 'Monk'. The tail of the Monkey Mind, the EY, is nothing but its Ever-Yelling and Ever-Yearning character. Our MonkEY Mind has a tail, the EY. The EY is 'Ever Yelling' and 'Ever Yearning'.

Source: Chapter 17 – *Cut The Monkey's Tail* | Page 49 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How do we cut the monkey's tail and tame the Monkey Mind?

A: You cut its tail. There is no other way. The tail of the Monkey Mind, the EY, is nothing but its Ever-Yelling and Ever-Yearning character. To stop this yelling, we must spend time in silence. We must meditate and contemplate in Consciousness. We must move from a state of Mind to a state of intellect, from thoughts to Thoughtlessness.

Source: Chapter 17 – *Cut The Monkey's Tail* | Page 50 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What does it mean to make the Monkey into a Monk?

A: In a state of a Monk, one becomes: M – Master of the Mind, O – Only in Yoga, N – No Desires, K – Karma Transcended. One of our life's greatest challenges is to be like a Monk because then, we can have Peace, the very foundation of Happiness.

Source: Chapter 17 – *Cut The Monkey's Tail* | Page 51 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How does the Monkey Mind make us a 'donkey'?

A: Not only is it a monkey but it is such a Rascal Monkey that it makes us a donkey. It takes over the command of our life from our hands and we become helpless and swing like a pendulum with it, from the past to the future. Unless we stop this monkey business, we will just cry and suffer, till we die.

Source: Chapter 5 – *The Mind Is A Monkey* | Page 14 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is 'Ever-Yelling' of the Monkey Mind?

A: Because of all the noise that the Mind creates, we cannot hear the Divine voice, the voice of the truth that is within. Our Mind is engrossed in the world of politics, money, name, fame and materialism. It gets caught in television, internet and mobile phones. There is so much noise that this yelling adds to our stress and anxiety.

Source: Chapter 17 – Cut The Monkey's Tail | Page 50 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is 'Ever-Yearning' of the Monkey Mind?

A: The Ever-Yearning Mind says, 'I want this, I want that!' It doesn't know how to stop even after we fulfil our needs. It gets caught in greed. Such is the nature of the Monkey Mind. We have to cut its tail EY that is Ever-Yearning. Wealth, we earn and earn and earn, only for others to burn, whatever we earn!

Source: Chapter 17 – Cut The Monkey's Tail | Page 50 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Why does the Monkey Mind not stay still?

A: The monkey does not want to be still because the moment the Monkey Mind is still, we can kill it! In the state of Thoughtlessness, when there are no thoughts, we reach Consciousness, in which our intellect shines. The moment our intellect is in command, our Mind can no more be a monkey that keeps jumping from yesterday to tomorrow.

Source: Chapter 5 – The Mind Is A Monkey | Page 14 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Why is the Mind also said to be like the Phoenix?

A: The Phoenix is a mythological bird known to rise from its own ashes with a renewed vigour. Just like the Phoenix never dies, our Mind seems to be deathless too. Even though we still it and kill it, it rises from its death, just like the Phoenix. Therefore, it is a big challenge to deal with the Mind.

Source: Chapter 15 – The Mind Is Like The Phoenix | Page 43 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How should I deal with the Monkey Mind every time it returns?

A: Those who imagine that killing the Mind is a one-time affair are in for a surprise. Every time they still the Mind, kill the Mind and move into Consciousness, the Phoenix Mind returns to attack with thoughts. The intelligent ones are aware. They are ever ready for their Mind to return. They build a dam so that the gushing waters of the Mind do not flood in and destroy their Peace.

Source: Chapter 15 – The Mind Is Like The Phoenix | Page 45 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What does the Monkey Mind do to our present moment?

A: The Monkey Mind causes fear, worry, stress and anxiety. When we let the Monkey Mind jump from a past that is gone to a future, not yet born, it steals our present moment and along with it, our Peace and Happiness.

Source: Preface to Second Edition | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How can practicing moments of Thoughtlessness tame the Monkey Mind?

A: Unless we practice moments of Thoughtlessness, where the Monkey Mind stops jumping from thought to thought, we will not enjoy moments of Peace, Bliss and Consciousness. Somehow, our Mind has made us believe in the lie that we are nothing without it and little do we realize that our Mind is our biggest enemy.

Source: Chapter 5 – *The Mind Is A Monkey* | Page 15 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is 'Rotten-thought-itis'?

A: People who are always in a bad mood, suffer from what we call, 'Rotten-thought-itis'. This disease is more dangerous than other diseases like tuberculosis and hepatitis because when we are infected with rotten thoughts, we have toxic emotions within us that create not just a rotten mood that swings from fear, worry and stress but continues into rotten dreams that wake us up with misery.

Source: Chapter 11 – *Thoughts And Dreams* | Page 33 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How does the Monkey Mind affect our dreams?

A: If we tame the Monkey Mind and make it a Monk, we will improve our sleep too because it is the same Mind that remains awake when the body sleeps. Our Mind is nothing but a bundle of thoughts. This bundle of thoughts creates the illusory mind and makes us dream. If there are toxic emotions in our head, then it will be normal for us to have nightmares.

Source: Chapter 11 – *Thoughts And Dreams* | Page 32 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the ultimate challenge in taming the Monkey Mind?

A: It is said that the one who has conquered the Mind has conquered the world. As long as we are alive, we cannot really kill the Mind but we can tame it. Once we tame the monkey into a Monk, the Mind is no more King. It is the intellect then, that occupies the throne and we live in that state of Consciousness.

Source: *Preface to Second Edition* | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

TOPIC: POSITIVE THINKING AND THE THOUGHT CHAIN

Q: What is the Thought Chain?

A: Thoughts create feelings. Feelings create actions. Actions create habits. Habits create character. And character creates destiny. This is 'The Thought Chain'. We cannot intercept the chain because it has a domino effect, one follows the other. But what controls thoughts? It is emotions.

Source: Chapter 10 – *The Thought Chain* | Page 28 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is NEP?

A: NEP is Negative Energy that is Poison, the negative emotions that we feed our Mind that create poison in our life. Emotions like fear, worry, stress, anxiety, anger, hate, revenge, jealousy and pessimism. The very thought of such emotions creates depression in our life. If we don't choose PEP, by default our Mind will choose NEP.

Source: Chapter 9 – *From NEP To PEP* | Page 26 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is PEP?

A: If we choose emotions like Optimism, Faith, Hope, Belief, Trust, Courage, Confidence and Forgiveness, then we are supplying positive raw material to our Thought Factory, our Mind, to produce positive thoughts. These positive emotions create PEP, Positive Energy Power.

Source: Chapter 9 – From NEP To PEP | Page 26 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How do we flip from NEP to PEP?

A: To control the Rascal Mind, the first thing we must learn to do is to flip from NEP, Negative Energy Poison to PEP, Positive Energy Power. If we feed the Mind with positive raw material, it will produce positive thoughts, just like if we feed it with negative raw material, it will produce negative thoughts.

Source: Chapter 9 – From NEP To PEP | Page 25 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Can we choose our emotions?

A: Emotions are a choice. We can choose either positive or negative emotions, love or hate, faith or fear, revenge or forgiveness. Emotions are those strong feelings that we choose. They in fact, become our attitude, based on which, we react. Once we have chosen our emotions, then we are no more in-charge of our thoughts.

Source: Chapter 9 – From NEP To PEP | Page 26 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How do thoughts lead to destiny?

A: Looking back, what created our destiny? It was our thoughts that created feelings and actions. But how are thoughts created? The emotions that we choose to live by, create our thoughts. Therefore, choosing the emotions that we fill our life with, is a very important aspect. NEP or PEP, the emotion that we choose decides our destiny.

Source: Chapter 10 – The Thought Chain | Page 29 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Why does positive thinking alone not always work?

A: The whole world talks of positive thinking but how can we make our Mind think positive when it always thinks negative? The illusory Mind is a Thought Factory. It produces thoughts, based only on the raw materials that we feed it. The biggest problem with our Mind is that it constantly makes us miserable.

Source: Chapter 9 – From NEP To PEP | Page 25 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How does attitude affect destiny?

A: What causes our attitude to be positive or negative? It is emotions. 'Emotion' means Energy in Motion. Our attitude is controlled by emotions. When we are in a Mind state, our reactions are spontaneous. These reactions are based on the emotions that are filled in our 'think-tank'. This we can choose but if we don't choose our emotions, then we lose the battle with our Mind.

Source: Chapter 9 – From NEP To PEP | Page 27 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the relationship between emotions, thoughts, and habits?

A: When we fill our life with love, faith, hope and compassion, these emotions become the basic raw material that lead us to a positive destiny. Whatever happens in our life, we will react positively! Positive thoughts that become positive feelings, result in positive actions. When a person repeats their actions, again and again, those actions become a habit.

Source: Chapter 10 – The Thought Chain | Page 28 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What happens when we fill our life with negative emotions?

A: If we don't choose Courage, Confidence, Faith, Hope and Optimism, our Mind will, by default, choose pessimism, fear and worry. These negative emotions will become the raw material for our Thought Factory, our Mind, and we will always react negatively, with anger, hate, revenge and jealousy. This negative attitude will further progress into negative thoughts and create negative feelings all the time.

Source: Chapter 10 – The Thought Chain | Page 29 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: How can I break the cycle of negative thinking?

A: Therefore, the first step in Mind Management, even before we kill the Mind, is to still the Mind and fill it with PEP because the moment our Mind is full of NEP, it becomes charged like a dangerous beast that can destroy our Peace and Happiness. The simplest thing is to flip over from NEP to PEP. Then, we can control our thoughts, attitude, actions and ultimately, our destiny.

Source: Chapter 9 – From NEP To PEP | Page 27 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Why do bad dreams occur and how to prevent them?

A: So, the next time you wake up from a nightmare, do not waste even a minute reflecting on it. Brush it aside with positive thoughts, which you can consciously bring about by choosing positive emotions and a positive attitude. Otherwise, you will start another day with a bad mood where your Rascal Mind will steal your Peace and Happiness.

Source: Chapter 11 – Thoughts And Dreams | Page 33 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What does 'Garbage in, Garbage out' mean for the Mind?

A: The Mind is like a popcorn machine. If caramel corn are fed into the popcorn machine, we will get caramel popcorn. If salted corn are put into the machine, we will get salted popcorn. Like they say, 'Garbage in, garbage out!' Therefore, whatever we put in our so-called Mind is very important.

Source: Chapter 9 – From NEP To PEP | Page 25 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: Is destiny completely pre-determined or do our choices matter?

A: No doubt, some things in our life unfold as per our past Karma, our past actions. But thereafter, we have been given a free will. We have been given a freedom of choice. We can choose our present actions, form our present Karma. Our destiny is in our hands despite our past Karma.

Source: Chapter 10 – The Thought Chain | Page 30 | *The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*

Q: What is the simplest first step to manage the Mind?

A: The simplest thing is to flip over from NEP to PEP. Then, we can control our thoughts, attitude, actions and ultimately, our destiny. If we choose PEP, Positive Energy Power, then our life will be full of Peace and Bliss. But if we choose NEP, we are sure to reach a destiny of unhappiness.

Source: *Chapter 10 – The Thought Chain | Page 30 | The Mind is a Rascal (2nd Edition)*